

Rushal Butala

rbutala@umich.edu | 602-245-6745 | LinkedIn | GitHub | Portfolio

Summary

UX Engineer specializing in design systems and frontend architecture. Strong at translating Figma systems into scalable React/TypeScript implementations, enforcing accessibility standards, and shipping production UI in fast-moving startups.

Experience

Borough

Early-stage Civic Tech Startup

Founding UX Engineer

Jul 2025 – Nov 2025

- Architected and built the platform's full-stack infrastructure using FastAPI and PostgreSQL to support real-time, high-volume communication, reducing average response latency by 25%.
- Integrated a vector-database-driven RAG pipeline for contextual retrieval with ranking, and caching layers.
- Deployed services to Google Cloud Platform using cost-efficient compute, networking, and storage configurations.
- Owned end-to-end UX and frontend implementation for resident- and government-facing interfaces using React and TypeScript.
- Designed and maintained a tokenized design system in Figma aligned directly with production UI.
- Conducted 30+ user interviews and contextual inquiries, translating insights into interaction flows, MVP scope, and feature prioritization.
- Ensured WCAG-compliant accessibility across web and mobile through contrast validation, touch target sizing, and visual hierarchy.

Next Play Games

Fantasy Sports Startup

Lead Designer (Frontend-Focused)

May 2024 – Aug 2024

- Led end-to-end UX for a consumer web app, collaborating closely with frontend engineers.
- Built and documented a reusable component library to improve UI consistency and developer velocity.
- Ran usability testing and A/B experiments to refine interaction patterns and reduce drop-off.

Savance

Enterprise SaaS

Software Engineer (UI & Dashboards)

Jun 2024 – Aug 2024

- Designed and implemented frontend dashboards for operational data visualization.
- Collaborated with designers and stakeholders to align UI behavior with real-world workflows.
- Maintained accessibility standards and clean Git workflows in a multi-engineer codebase.

Quicken

UX Consultant

Jan 2024 – May 2024

Ann Arbor, MI

- Enhanced the user interface through industry and competitor research, updating UI patterns to improve usability and ensure WCAG-compliant accessibility.
- Delivered 10+ actionable UX recommendations based on surveys (Qualtrics), heuristic evaluation, and usability testing, improving task success rate by 2x.

The Bulletin.io

Chicago, IL

Software Engineering Intern

May 2021 – Jan 2022

- Built a real-time transit dashboard using JavaScript frameworks and Google Maps APIs.
- Improved UI performance by 50% through client-side optimization and caching strategies.

Projects

Faabl — AI Storytelling Toy

- Designed and prototyped an AI-powered storytelling product spanning physical and digital UX.
- Owned interaction design, system flows, and high-fidelity prototypes used for demos and pitch decks.

Reap Rewards

- Researched the problem space with qualitative research methods like user interviews and competitive analysis.
- Developed comprehensive design artifacts including personas, complex site maps, user flow, information architecture diagrams, and wireframes using industry-standard tools like FigJam.
- Designed high-fidelity prototypes in Figma with complex interactions.

Transcribify — iOS App

- Built with Swift/SwiftUI using TDD, reducing transcription latency by 30% via concurrent processing.

CLAWS — NASA Spacesuit Communication Tool

- Fullstack React, TypeScript, Node.js app with WebSockets for astronaut-ground real-time communication.

Skills

Frontend / UX Engineering: React, TypeScript, JavaScript, Design Systems, Accessibility (WCAG), Figma-to-Code

Backend (Supporting): Node.js, Python (FastAPI), REST APIs

Tools: Figma, Git, GraphQL, Firebase, Docker, Photoshop, Jest